

Mini Paper — 1.5 Legal, Moral, Cultural & Ethical Issues

Time: ~35 minutes · Total: 30 marks · Answer all questions.

Mark your work against the mark scheme at the end; aim for ~1 minute per mark.

Questions

1. State the **three offences** under the Computer Misuse Act 1990 and give **one example** of each. [4] (AO1)

2. A fitness-app company stores users' names, email addresses, locations and heart-rate data. Describe **two principles** of the Data Protection Act 2018 / GDPR the company must follow, explaining what each means for how it handles this data. [4] (AO1/AO2)

3. A disgruntled employee uses a manager's password to log into the company file server, copies a confidential client list, and then deletes several project files before leaving. Identify **which law and which offence(s)** have been broken, mapping each action to an offence, and justify your answer. [5] (AO2)

4. A software developer copies a section of source code from a rival company's product into their own application and sells it. **(a)** Name the law that has been breached and explain why copying the code is an offence. **[3]** (AO1/AO2)

(b) Explain why copying the rival's *underlying idea or algorithm*, rather than the code, would **not** be an offence under this law. **[2]** (AO2)

5. A national government proposes a new system that uses **artificial intelligence and automated decision making** to decide which citizens receive welfare benefits, replacing human caseworkers. The AI is trained on years of historical claims data.

*Discuss the moral, ethical, legal and social issues raised by this proposal. Consider the impact on different stakeholders, weigh the benefits and drawbacks, and reach a **justified conclusion**.* **[12]** (AO2/AO3)

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